

"Communication and Collaboration Model"

Based on the slides from "Communication and Collaboration Model", here is a comprehensive list of **short and descriptive questions with their answers**, covering all key topics discussed in the presentation.

Short Questions with Answers

1. Do all computer systems affect group interactions?

Answer:

Yes, all computer systems, even those not designed for collaboration, influence group interactions and dynamics.

2. What is groupware?

Answer:

Groupware refers to systems specifically designed to support teamwork and collaboration (e.g., Google Docs, Microsoft Teams, Slack).

3. What happens if group dynamics are ignored in system design?

Answer:

Ignoring group dynamics can lead to:

- Poor user adoption
 - Miscommunication
 - Workflow bottlenecks
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4. What are examples of communication types in HCI?

Answer:

- Face-to-face communication

- Text-based communication
 - Conversation-based communication
 - Group collaboration
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5. What is the importance of face-to-face communication?

Answer:

Face-to-face communication is the most fundamental form, involving eye contact, gestures, and body language for subtle understanding.

6. What are the challenges of text-based communication?

Answer:

- Slower pace
 - Less feedback
 - Reduced emotional context
 - Easier to reference and review
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7. What is meant by group collaboration in HCI?

Answer:

Group collaboration involves shared task management, decision-making, version control, and coordinated workflows using digital tools.

8. Why are field studies in group work more complex?

Answer:

Because they must consider real-world social dynamics, cultural norms, and unpredictable group behaviors.

9. What are back channels in communication?

Answer:

Back channels are subtle verbal and non-verbal cues (e.g., nodding, "mm-hmm") that show engagement in conversations.

10. How do media affect back-channel communication?

Answer:

Each medium limits back-channel cues differently:

- **Video:** Loss of body language
 - **Audio:** Loss of facial expressions
 - **Half-duplex:** Disrupts real-time response
 - **Text:** No back-channel cues at all
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11. What is turn-taking in communication?

Answer:

Turn-taking is the natural flow where speakers pause, and listeners respond using cues like expressions or small sounds.

Descriptive Questions with Answers

1. Explain how all computer systems affect group dynamics.

Answer:

All computer systems—whether collaborative or individual—affect how people communicate, coordinate, and share work. Even tools like word processors or note apps impact how groups handle tasks and share ideas. Ignoring this group effect can lead to poor adoption and ineffective communication.

2. Describe the consequences of ignoring group interaction in system design.

Answer:

Ignoring group dynamics can lead to:

- **Poor user adoption:** If the system lacks collaboration tools, teams may avoid using it.
 - **Miscommunication:** Without proper communication channels, mistakes and delays occur.
 - **Workflow bottlenecks:** Rigid or non-intuitive design slows down team efficiency.
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3. What are the key differences between face-to-face and digital communication?

Answer:

- **Face-to-face:** Involves full body language, tone, eye contact, personal space.
- **Digital communication:** Often lacks immediate feedback, context, and back channels.

Humans carry their expectations from face-to-face interactions into digital media, which can cause misunderstandings.

4. Explain how cultural norms affect digital communication.

Answer:

People bring their **greeting styles, politeness rules, and turn-taking habits** into online platforms. When these norms are not supported or recognized digitally, it may lead to perceived rudeness or miscommunication.

5. How does video communication affect personal space and eye contact?

Answer:

- Video disrupts **natural eye contact** because people look at the screen instead of the camera.
 - It challenges **personal space boundaries**, though the "glass wall" (screen) helps create comfort.
 - Despite limitations, **poor video is better than audio-only** for expressing emotions and presence.
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6. Discuss how different media restrict back-channel feedback.

Answer:

Medium	Limitation
Video	Reduces subtle gestures
Audio	Removes visual cues (facial expressions)
Half-Duplex	Only one person can speak at a time

Text	No tone, expressions, or feedback cues
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Back channels help listeners express engagement and speakers adjust accordingly. Without them, interactions feel unnatural.

7. Describe the challenges of turn-taking in remote communication.

Answer:

- In normal speech, turn-taking happens with pauses and small cues.
- In **remote communication**, delays and lack of back-channel signals lead to:
 - Confusion
 - Interruptions
 - Unintentional monologues

Especially in international or laggy calls, people miss the timing to take turns smoothly.

8. Why do humans need communication systems?

Answer:

Humans are **naturally social** and depend on communication for living, working, and bonding. Digital systems should support and enhance these interactions through effective design and collaboration tools.

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